

Lessons

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Complex Figures

< >

Complex Figures

Toolbox



Complex Figures

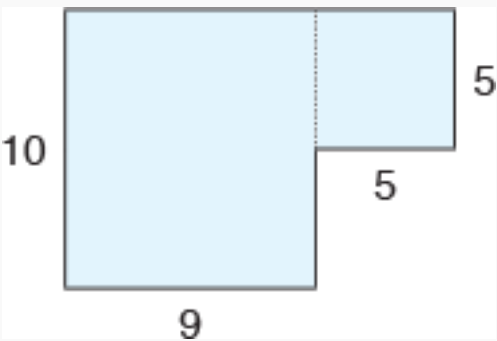
A complex figure is made from more than one shape. The area of a complex figure can’t be found using a single formula. Instead, you have to develop a plan of your own for finding the area.

Some figures can be cut up into smaller pieces. The area is the sum of the areas of these smaller shapes.

Example 1

Hide

What is the area of the figure in square inches?



Step 1

Divide the figure into smaller parts.

Here, the figure is divided into a rectangle and a square.

Step 2

Find the areas of the parts.

Rectangle: $A = 10 \cdot 9$
 $= 90 \text{ sq in}$

Square: $A = 5 \cdot 5$
 $= 25 \text{ sq in}$

Step 3

Find the total area

$90 + 25 = 115 \text{ sq in}$

Some complex figures appear to be missing a piece. You can subtract the area of the missing piece from the area of the larger figure.

Example 2

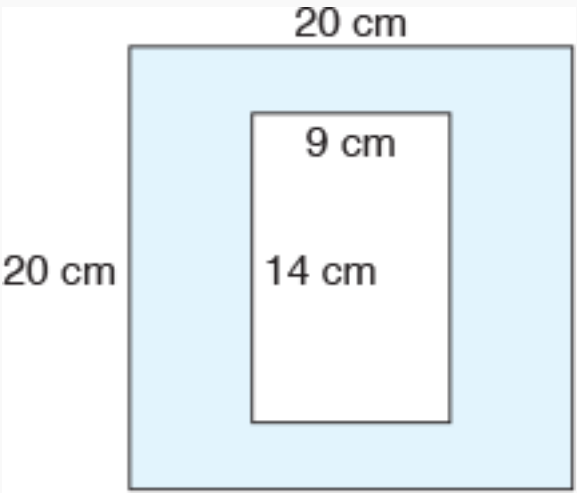
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What is the area of the shaded part of the figure?

Step 1

Divide the figure into smaller parts.

A rectangle is cut out of a square.



Step 2

Find the areas of the parts.

Square: $A = 20 \cdot 20$
 $= 400 \text{ cm}^2$

Rectangle: $A = 14 \cdot 9$
 $= 126 \text{ cm}^2$

Step 3

Find the area of the shaded portion.

$400 - 126 = 274 \text{ cm}^2$

When you are working with a complex figure, there is almost always more than one way to solve the problem. Look at the measurements you are given, and choose the way that seems easiest for you.

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Category

Lesson 3: Circles and Complex Figures

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